

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced
雅思口语高级
——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 7 Culture

Topic 1—Lesson 1(上篇)

A festival that is important in your country



I. Pronunciation Practice (2 minutes)

the 'sts' Cluster

Sometimes in certain consonant clusters (a string of two or more consonants in a word) the sounds may be reduced or dropped. In the consonant cluster 'sts', the /t/ can be dropped.

Read the following sentences and pay attention to the 'sts' cluster.



1. A Porche **costs** way too much for me.
2. The **masts** on the sailing ship were over forty feet tall.
3. Most students are not that fond of **tests**.

II. IELTS Speaking Part 1 (8 minutes)



Extend your answer to 3-4 sentences. It's easier to get 7.5.

1. Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (4 minutes)

What kind of clothes do you dislike? **Why/why not?**

How important are clothes and fashion to you? **Why?**

How different are the clothes you wear now from those you wore 10 years ago?



The examiner will score your answer from the following aspects:

1. How good you are at **keeping talking** at the right speed and **connecting your ideas together**;
2. **How much vocabulary** you have and **how well** you use it;
3. **How many structures** you have and **how well** you use them;
4. How well you **pronounce** the language.

2. Read and learn the following key words and models for the IELTS Part 1. You are suggested to apply these words in the following steps. (4 minutes)

Key Words and Models

heat up

 Example: I dislike formal types of clothing, or more particularly suit jackets and ties. Personally, these kinds of clothes are too restrictive and do not allow for a high range of movements. Also, at least for me, I **heat up** rather quickly, so when I wear a suit, I get sweaty, and feel really uncomfortable. A tie also has the same effect on me, as it seems to choke way too much around the neck area, causing me to blush more frequently.

hold sth. in high esteem

 Example: I personally do not **hold** fashion **in** very **high esteem** for several reasons. The first reason is that above all else I consider what I wear to serve a specific function, like hats to provide shade from the sun or coats to provide warmth, so for me to wear something just as a fashion statement is out of the question. Another reason is that if you were to always stay up to date with current fashion trends, you would need to spend an outrageous amount of money, which I consider to be a waste.

elaborate

 Example: I must admit that my taste in clothes currently has changed dramatically compared to 10 years ago. I once wore colourful clothes with **elaborate** patterns ; they have been replaced with blended colours that are far more versatile in their pairing with everyday clothing. I also used to wear sandals more frequently; however, now I tend to wear boots or tennis shoes, which I consider more functional.

III. IELTS Speaking Part 2 (12 minutes)

1. Brainstorm. Plan your answers based on the given questions. (1 minute)

Describe a festival that is important in your country.

- When does the festival occur?
- What did you do during it?
- What do you like or dislike about it?
- Why is this festival important?



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.1 Here is a model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (8 minutes)

Model 1

When: The most popular and widely celebrated festival in my country is the Spring Festival, also known as the Chinese New Year. This festival celebrates the turn of the Chinese lunar calendar which takes place on the last day of the last month on the calendar and runs until the 15th of the first month, which is actually the Lantern Festival.

What: Since the lunar calendar has a **sporadic cycle**, the beginning of the Spring Festival can fall on any day between January 21st and February 20th. Many of the traditions and customs associated with this festival vary from region to region, but many families will decorate their homes with red **paper cutouts** to symbolise wealth and longevity. Also, many families will have a reunion dinner on the day preceding the Chinese New Year's day. Similar to the average family, I have always held the same customs and traditions in high esteem.

What you dislike: Everything about this festival is amazing and the only thing I dread about it is travelling to and from my destinations, as this holiday season sees the biggest **migration** of Chinese travellers of any other days.

Why: I imagine that this festival is important for the same reason shared by other festivals around the world, which is that they bring families together and allow you to show your affection while you are enjoying authentic cultural traditions and customs.



You are required to talk for the full 2 minutes.

2.2 Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (3 minutes)

Describe a festival that is important in your country.

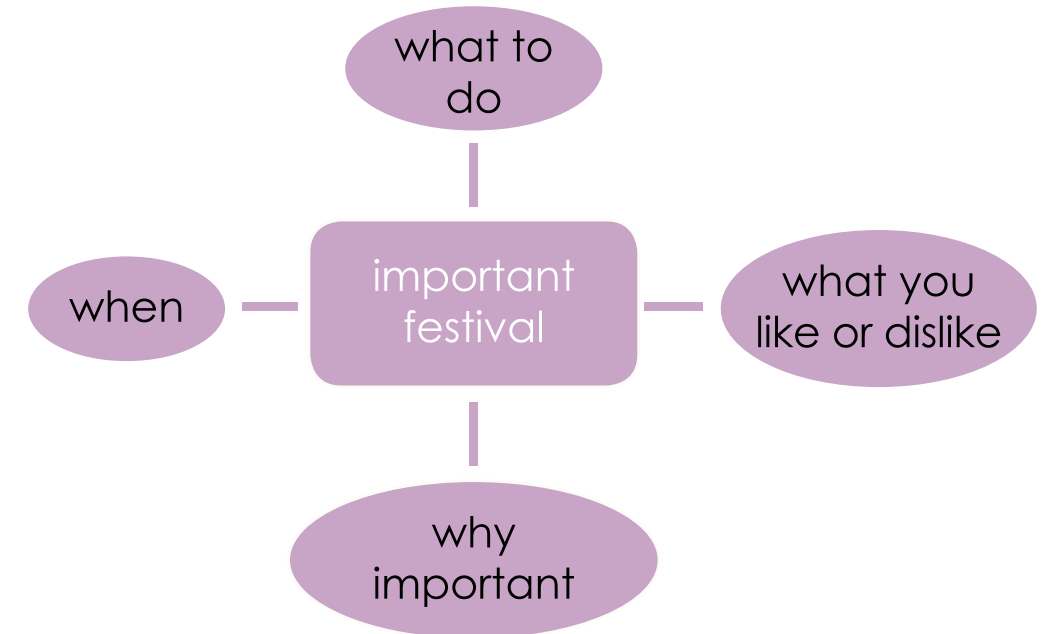
You should say:

when the festival occurs

what you did during it

what you like or dislike about it

and **explain why** this festival is important.



Homework: Please use the model for these two topics for further practice.

Describe a festival in your country.

Describe a holiday in your country.

Review (2 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

heat up

hold sth. in high esteem

elaborate

sporadic cycle

paper cutout

migration



Key Sentences

Also, at least for me, I **heat up** rather quickly, so when I wear a suit, I get sweaty, and feel really uncomfortable.

I personally do not **hold** fashion **in** very **high esteem** for several reasons.

I once wore colourful clothes with **elaborate** patterns.

Since the lunar calendar has a **sporadic cycle**, the beginning of the Spring Festival can fall on any day between January 21st and February 20th.

But many families will decorate their homes with red **paper cutouts** to symbolise wealth and longevity.

This holiday season sees the biggest **migration** of Chinese travellers of any other days.

You will learn more about this topic in Lesson 2.